

Alex Rivera

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with seven years building **payment and data platforms** in TypeScript and Go. Comfortable owning a service from design review to on-call, and happiest where reliability work pays for itself in fewer incidents.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Observability

PostgreSQL

Kubernetes

Distributed Systems

API Design

Event-Driven Architecture

TypeScript

Go

WORK EXPERIENCE

Northwind Payments March 2022 – Present

Senior Backend Engineer

Remote

- Rebuilt the settlement pipeline as an event-driven service in Go, cutting end-of-day reconciliation from **4 hours to 25 minutes**.
- Led the move from cron jobs to a queue-backed scheduler with idempotent retries; payment-related incidents fell **60%** in two quarters.
- Introduced OpenTelemetry tracing across 14 services and wrote the runbooks the on-call rotation now uses.

Contoso Analytics June 2019 – February 2022

Backend Engineer

Austin, TX

- Designed the public REST API for the reporting product (TypeScript, PostgreSQL), serving 3,000 customer integrations.
- Cut p95 query latency from 1.8 s to 300 ms by reworking indexes and adding a read replica for heavy reports.
- Mentored three junior engineers through their first production launches.

Fabrikam Labs July 2017 – May 2019

Software Engineer

Austin, TX

- Built internal tooling in Node.js for test-data generation, used by every QA team in the company.
- Containerized the legacy monolith and wrote its first Kubernetes deployment manifests.

PROJECTS

pg-shadow Open Source

Replays production query traffic against a candidate schema to catch slow migrations before they ship.

Go, PostgreSQL

SKILLS

Languages: Go, TypeScript, SQL, Python Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS Data: PostgreSQL, Kafka, Redis

CERTIFICATIONS		
Certified Kubernetes Application Developer	CNCF	2023

EDUCATION		
B.S. Computer Science	University of Texas at Austin	2017